And yet Gandhi had undoubted virtues which enabled him to attract the accolade of a ‘Mahatma’. What these were have withstood the test of time. Pritam Singh, however, has explained, ‘Gandhi’s strength was his unflinching, even arrogant, commitment to non-violence and what he considered to be truth.’ On the other hand, Gandhi’s weakness was ‘his utter lack of understanding of the process of global capital accumulation and imperialism and the insertion of India into the global capitalist framework.’[8] Gandhi was mercilessly ridiculed for his beliefs by socialists such as Yusuf Meherali, who was unequivocal in his assertion, ‘We do not believe in the change of heart theory, to which Mahatmaji attaches so much importance.’ This was because ‘[t]o our mind, imperialism has no heart to change, it has only pockets to fill’.[9] Gandhi may have displayed his genius in understanding ‘Hinduism’, the religion of the majority of India’s population, when coining the phrase ‘Ram Rajya’ (i.e., rule by the Hindu god ‘Ram’), but in so doing he distanced himself from and isolated the Muslim population of India, thus paving the way to the eventual creation of Pakistan. He was even less charitable to the Sikhs of India, such that, as Pritam Singh observes, ‘he never had any influence, whatsoever, amongst the Sikhs after his arrogant characterisation of Guru Gobind Singh as a misguided leader’, and it is also ‘doubtful if he had any serious influence amongst the Christians’. Gandhi’s view of Guru Gobind Singh stands in stark contrast to that of Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941), a man of letters and the first Indian to be awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature for his compilation *Gitanjali*, who was knighted by the British in 1915 but only for him to later renounce the accolade bestowed upon him after the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre in 1919. He wrote of Guru Gobind’s moments of joy and sorrow, of his triumphs and empathy, with considerable empathy. In *Bir Guru*, his first work, written when he was in his twenties, Tagore wrote that the Guru fought for ‘oppressed humanity’ and laid down his life in order to bring an end to Mughal authority in Punjab. When Tagore was later disillusioned with what he called the ‘degrading mendicancy policy’ of the Indian National Congress of the 1880s, he wrote *Guru Gobinda*, where he made no secret of his admiration of Guru Gobind Singh, and in *Nishpal*